

The 6:15

THURSDAY · SEPTEMBER 10, 2026

NO. 12

THE BOARD

CALENDAR (NEXT 10 DAYS)

Thu 9/10 (today)	Adobe (ADBE) fiscal Q3, after close — cons. adj. EPS \$6.09/\$6.7B rev., inside guide, little beat room. Oracle (ORCL) fiscal Q1 FY27, after close — cons. adj. EPS ~\$1.74-1.75/~\$19.1B rev.; RPO backlog was \$638B at FYE (+363% y/y); cloud rev. guided +58-64%.
Thu 9/11	Aug. CPI, 8:30a (BLS) — cons. headline +0.4% m/m/3.4% y/y; core +0.4% m/m/2.4% y/y (TD Securities outlier: 2.3% y/y). Weekly jobless claims, same hour.
Tue 9/15	Delaware statewide primary — last 2026 primary contest on the calendar; Rhode Island's ran 9/9.
Tue 9/15	[NEW/scheduled] SpaceX Starship Flight 14 — 3rd flight of V3, first Starship flight tasked with deploying Starlink satellites to stable LEO.
Tue-Wed 9/15-16	FOMC — decision/SEP Wed 2p, presser 2:30p. Hike odds diverge by venue: CME FedWatch ~56%, Kalshi 57%, Polymarket 49%.
[DEVELOPING]	Anthropic's public IPO prospectus still not located as filed this run despite an "after Labor Day" target reported last week; confidential S-1 on file with SEC since 6/1; late-Sept./early-Oct. Nasdaq listing still the reported target.

Correction: last issue carried Oracle's earnings for Mon 9/14 — Oracle's own investor-relations release sets today, 9/10, confirmed this run. No verified VC round of note or frontier-model release fell in this run's window.

METRICS · AS OF ~6:15A ET THU 9/10 UNLESS NOTED

Oil	Brent \$100.73 (Wed 9/9 settle, +\$2.81), intraday high \$100.95 — first close above \$100 since Jul. 24; WTI \$96.24 (Wed 9/9) [single-sourced: Buckhead Energy] ; spread ~\$4.49.
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Rates	10Y 4.83% (Wed 9/9); 2Y 4.39% (last avail., Tue 9/8); 30Y 5.30% (Wed 9/9).
FX/Vol	DXY 98.48 (Wed 9/9 a.m.), Bloomberg called it a 7-month low, Yahoo a 4-month low (sources diverge), yen-driven; VIX 14.15 (Wed 9/9, -1.19%).
Futures	Dow futures -332pts (-0.6%), S&P futures -0.2% [timing approximate, ~pre-market Thu] .
Equities (Wed 9/9 close)	Dow 52,380.66 (-0.77%, -405.41pts); S&P 500 7,636.36 (-0.48%); Nasdaq Comp. 26,253.34 (-0.64%) — oil/yields pressure.
Asia/Europe	Nikkei 66,399.84 (+2.12%); Kospi 6,995.39 (+4.61%); Hang Seng -0.85%; Stoxx 600 flat, DAX -0.25%, FTSE 100 -0.1%, CAC 40 +0.33%, FTSE MIB +0.25% [Mon 9/7 close, most recent located this run] .
Gold/Gas	Gold >\$4,400/oz (Wed 9/9, ending a 3-session decline); retail gas \$4.2245/gal natl. avg (AAA, 9/9).

Crude: ICE Brent/NYMEX WTI front-month. Rates: Fed H.15/CME. Equities: exchange closes via CNBC. No fresher Asia/Europe close than Monday's was located this run — flagged rather than estimated.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Closure	Day 194 (globalsecurity.org, wider war count) vs. Day 192 (straits.live, own start date) — different baselines, not reconciled.
Transits	Kpler 10-day avg. 13/day; Lloyd's List Intelligence ~12/day (8/26-9/1); straits.live single-day count 6 on 8/30 vs. ~85/day baseline (~7% of normal) — three different windows/methodologies.
Dark tankers	"Majority" of crossings classified dark/unknown by route as of late Aug. (Al Jazeera) [qualitative, single-sourced, no % located] .
War-risk premia	~\$10.0M/VLCC passage, ~40x peacetime (straits.live) — unchanged order of magnitude.
Strikes (24h)	No fresh strike confirmed in the strict last 24h to press time; most recent major exchange (CENTCOM vs. 5 Iranian tankers, Iran's Jordan barrage) was Tue-Wed, detailed in Lead/Iran & Hormuz. Running total not maintained by this issue.

Kpler's AIS-based daily counts, Lloyd's List's weekly averages, and straits.live's day-specific snapshots measure different things over different windows — never netted or averaged. The 6-vs-12/13 spread partly reflects day-to-day volatility around a low base, not disagreement.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Beat Rockies 5-3 Tue (Judge's return, hitless; Schlittler 10 K's; Ramos 8th-inning HR) — 82-62. Wed finale result not confirmed as of press time.
Knicks	[DEVELOPING] Hart extension talks reportedly narrowing to a 3-yr/\$60-62M "sweet spot," tighter than the \$54-62M range floated last week; still unsigned.
Northwestern	Bye week — no game. 1-0 after beating South Dakota State 34-18 (9/5); next up Colorado, 9/19.

LEAD

THREE FRONTS, ONE 24-HOUR WINDOW

Brent tops \$100 for the first time since July as Iran hits a US ally's airbase in Jordan, Houthi strike Saudi refining country, and a Black Sea terminal takes a drone hit — the same 24 hours

Tuesday brought the sharpest single-day widening of the war since it began. US Central Command struck and destroyed or disabled five Iranian crude carriers — M/T Kaviz, Charminar, Horizon 1, Riesco and Derya — after the IRGC tried twice in two days to hit a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles; video of the Riesco sinking circulated within hours. [NEW] [fact] It is the same "tanker for tanker" doctrine Adm. Brad Cooper described after Saturday's smaller exchange, now applied at more than double the scale — two Iranian tankers disabled then, five sunk or disabled now. [fact]

Iran's retaliation landed somewhere new: overnight Tuesday into Wednesday, the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Muwaffaq Salti/Al Azraq air base, the principal host for US air operations in the kingdom. Jordanian and US Patriot PAC-3 batteries in-

tercepted 18; two fell in open areas; no casualties were reported. [NEW] [fact] Iranian state media (Fars) claimed the strike damaged maintenance hangars and F-35/F-16/F-15 dispersal sites; a Trump administration official called the barrage "ineffective against integrated air and missile defences." [fact — claims conflict, neither independently verified this run] It is the first time in this war that Iranian strikes have landed on Jordanian soil rather than at sea or inside Iran itself — a geographic widening, not just an escalation in tanker count. [read]

The same 24-hour window produced two more supply-side hits, on different continents. Iran-aligned Houthi forces fired missiles and drones at energy and economic sites across Saudi Arabia's south — Abha, Khamis Mushait, Jazan and Najran — Tuesday, wounding 73 and forcing a temporary halt to some operations near Jazan's 400,000-bpd refinery, one of the kingdom's largest. [NEW] [fact] And Wednesday morning, drones hit the Caspian Pipeline Consortium's Black Sea export terminal at Novorossiysk, damaging the tanker Seaviolet at mooring three; the vessel completed loading and the mooring itself was reported undamaged. [NEW] [fact, single-sourced to trade press this run] Neither CPC nor Ukraine has claimed responsibility; Russia has previously blamed Ukraine for the terminal's recurring drone strikes. [fact]

[read] The mechanism that matters for a portfolio is not any single strike but the pattern: three geographically distinct pieces of global supply — Iranian Gulf exports, Saudi refining capacity, and Kazakh Black Sea export infrastructure that routes around the Gulf entirely — all took hits inside one day. That is a different shock than the Hormuz chokepoint story the market has been pricing for 194 days, where the redundancy argument was that alternate routes and non-

Gulf refining capacity could absorb some of the loss. Wednesday's set of strikes narrows that redundancy on two of its own load-bearing pieces simultaneously. Brent's reaction — a \$2.81 jump to a \$100.73 settle, its first close above the century mark since July 24 — priced exactly that: not a single flashpoint, but the removal of slack.

Equities and rates moved together in the uncomfortable direction: the Dow fell 405 points (-0.77%) to 52,380.66, the S&P 500 slid 0.48% to 7,636.36, the Nasdaq eased 0.64%, while the 10-year rose to 4.83% and the 30-year to 5.30% — oil and yields both up is the stagflationary cross-current the Board has flagged for weeks, and it now sits directly in front of Thursday's CPI print. [fact] [read] Trump's public line — Iran "will be hit again at a much harder and higher level" if it retaliates further — plus Tehran's Foreign Ministry calling the US strikes "a clear threat to regional and international peace" both argue the tanker-for-tanker exchange is escalating in scale on both sides, not settling into a stable rhythm. That raises the stakes for Thursday's Aug. CPI (cons. +0.4% m/m/3.4% y/y): a hot print arriving on top of \$100 oil hands hawks a stronger case heading into the Sept. 15-16 FOMC than the already-contested 49-57% hike odds implied when Brent was trading \$20 cheaper.

POLITICS

Rhode Island held its statewide primary Wednesday, one of the last two 2026 primary contests remaining on the calendar; Delaware's follows Sept. 15, after which the general-election field is fully set for the Nov. 3 midterms. [NEW] [fact] No results from Rhode Island's primary were located this run [flag: not verified this run]. Republicans continue to hold the House 218-214 (three vacancies) and the Senate 53-45 (two independents caucusing with Democrats),

a narrow enough margin that either chamber's midterm outcome remains a live question for market-relevant policy (tax, tariff authority, AI regulation) heading into 2027. [continuity] Last week's NBC poll finding 69% opposition to new AI data-center construction in swing districts had no confirmed follow-on polling or campaign response located this run, but it sits awkwardly alongside Thursday's Oracle and Adobe prints, both leaning on the same AI-capex story that poll suggests is politically unpopular in the districts where much of that capex is sited. [read]

ECONOMICS

Fed funds remain targeted at 3.50%-3.75%; a hike at the Sept. 15-16 meeting takes the range to 3.75%-4.00%. [continuity] Thursday's Aug. CPI is the last scheduled data point before that vote, and forecasters have narrowed around a core print of 2.4% y/y (TD Securities alone at 2.3%), with prediction markets split closely enough — Polymarket's plurality actually sits on a softer 0.2% m/m core print — that Thursday's number, not this week's oil shock directly, remains the single biggest swing factor for the meeting. [fact] Hike-odds dispersion across venues (CME ~56%, Kalshi 57%, Polymarket 49%) is itself a signal: none of the three has moved decisively since Wednesday's oil and equity moves, suggesting markets are treating the war as an inflation risk to watch via Thursday's print rather than trading it directly into rate-path odds yet. [read] Away from Thursday's print, August's ISM Manufacturing PMI eased a point to 54.6 from July's 55.6 — still expansionary for an eighth straight month, just decelerating — while ISM Services rose 1.3 points to 55.4, its best reading since February and above consensus. [NEW] [fact] The split (softening factory activity, firming services) is the kind of divergence the Fed has cited before as evidence the

economy doesn't need aggressive tightening to cool, a data point doves on the committee can point to regardless of what Thursday's CPI shows. [read]

BUSINESS

Adobe and Oracle both report after Thursday's close — a rare same-day pairing of megacap software prints. Adobe's own guidance (\$6.05-6.10 EPS/\$6.67-6.72B revenue) sits close enough to the \$6.09/\$6.7B consensus that a clean beat looks unlikely without an upside surprise elsewhere in the mix. [continuity] Oracle enters with a \$638B remaining-performance-obligation backlog — up from \$553B a quarter earlier and 363% higher year-over-year on AI-contract volume — against management's own guide for 58-64% cloud revenue growth; investors are watching that backlog conversion alongside capital-spending and financing needs given the company's negative free cash flow this cycle. [NEW] [fact] Nvidia's \$12.93B Hugging Face acquisition (announced 9/2, still expected to close 1H 2027) continues to face regulatory scrutiny centered on vertical-foreclosure concerns, notwithstanding Nvidia's written commitment that its own compute won't be required to build on the platform. [continuity] The FTC's Amazon ad-auction suit — alleging roughly \$20B in advertiser overcharges since 2019 — remains in its opening stage; no new filings located this run. [continuity] Separately, the Transportation Secretary called Ford's use of Chinese battery technology "unacceptable" in a public letter, flagging the automaker's battery-supply deal with CATL and a joint venture with China's Geely as national-security concerns — the latest instance of Washington scrutinizing Chinese industrial partnerships inside Detroit's EV supply chain. [NEW] [fact] Separately again, US security agencies accused Chinese AI firms of "aggressive and mali-

cious" tactics to train their models, a claim reported alongside the Ford letter Wednesday but without specific companies or evidence named in what was located this run [flag: light on detail, not independently verified].

TECHNOLOGY

Apple unveiled a new product lineup Wednesday under CEO John Ternus — his first launch event since succeeding Tim Cook — headlined by the company's first foldable iPhone. [NEW] [fact] No pricing or shipping-date detail was verified this run [flag]. Separately, OpenAI is disputing credit after a claim that one of its models helped resolve a Millennium Prize-eligible math problem in 88 hours; the claim is contested and not independently verified this run [flag: single-sourced, disputed]. Qualcomm shares rose 3.2% Wednesday on optimism around a new AI data-center partnership with Amazon Web Services, the latest sign that chipmakers outside the Nvidia/AMD duopoly are finding footholds in AI infrastructure buildout. [NEW] [fact] GPT-6 Astra's rollout to Plus/Free ChatGPT tiers and Anthropic's IPO timeline both carry over unchanged from Monday's issue — no confirmed movement on either located this run. [continuity]

GEOPOLITICS

Russia fired an unspecified number of Iskander-M ballistic missiles, Banderol-type loitering munitions and 196 drones at targets across eleven Ukrainian regions plus the DPR overnight into Wednesday, wounding 14 (including two children) in Kyiv. [NEW] [fact] Ukraine struck back at Russia's Black Sea military infrastructure in Krasnodar Krai overnight, hitting the naval base at Novorossiysk and the frigate Admiral Essen, per Ukrainian defense-intelligence claims. [NEW] [fact] US envoys Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner shuttled between Moscow and Kyiv this week seeking to revive stalled peace talks; both sets of meetings produced no breakthrough, and strikes resumed on both sides once the delegation's visit-linked pause lapsed. [fact] The geographic proximity of Wednesday's Novorossiysk-area drone strike to the same night's CPC terminal drone hit (see Lead) was not established as connected by any source located this run [flag: coincidence not confirmed either way]. The Witkoff-Kushner shuttle produced one concrete result — the brief mutual pause on long-range strikes against Moscow and Kyiv that both sides observed through Sept. 7, per Monday's issue — but Wednesday's resumed strikes on both sides confirm that pause has now fully lapsed with no successor agreement reported. [fact] Zelensky's framing from Sunday, that Ukraine "expects the war will continue" through winter and is counting on US energy and air-defense support, reads consistently with this week's resumed tempo on both sides. [continuity]

IRAN & HORMUZ

The Tuesday-Wednesday exchange detailed in the Lead — five Iranian tankers destroyed or disabled, 20 Iranian missiles fired at Jordan's Al Azraq base, Houthi strikes wounding 73 in Saudi Arabia's south — is this issue's dominant Hormuz-adjacent story and is not repeated here. What it leaves for this section: the strait itself remains at a stated ~7% of normal throughput per straits.live's most granular (Aug. 30) snapshot, with no formal reopening and no fresher single-day count located this run. [flag: stale] The three-way divergence between Kpler's 13/day 10-day average, Lloyd's List's ~12/day weekly average, and straits.live's single-day 6-vessel count (Board, above) is wide enough that a reader should treat any one of them as directionally right and none as precise — averaging or differencing them would manufacture false confidence the underlying data doesn't support. [read] War-risk premia held at roughly 40x peacetime levels (~\$10.0M/VLCC passage, straits.live) — unchanged in order of magnitude since Monday's issue despite Tuesday-Wednesday's escalation, which itself is notable: the insurance market may already have been pricing something close to this scenario. [read] Saudi Arabia's own crude-export infrastructure sits well north of the Jazan refinery Tuesday's Houthi strikes touched — Ras Tanura and the Eastern Province terminals that handle the bulk of the kingdom's roughly 9-10M bpd of exports were not reported hit — so the immediate supply loss from Tuesday's attack runs through refined-product capacity (Jazan's 400,000 bpd) rather than crude export volume itself; that distinction matters for how durable Wednesday's price move proves to be once markets digest which piece of infrastructure actually went offline. [read] No update on Iran's own crude export volumes, sanctioned-tanker "dark fleet" size, or Chinese teapot-refinery intake was located this run [flag: not verified].

SPORTS

Yankees	Beat Rockies 5-3 Tue. (Judge's return; Schlittler 10 K's). 82-62, atop AL wild card, ~4 GB Tampa Bay (86-58) in AL East. Wed. result not confirmed.
Knicks	Hart extension talks narrowing toward 3-yr/\$60-62M; still unsigned.
Northwestern	Bye week, 1-0. Beat South Dakota State 34-18 (9/5); hosts Colorado 9/19.

Continuity. Dropped as unchanged since Monday's issue: OPEC+ October quotas (resolved 9/6, no new date until 2027); GPT-6 Astra's Plus/Free rollout status; Anthropic's IPO timeline. Corrected this issue: Oracle's earnings date, previously carried as Mon. 9/14, actually falls today (9/10) per Oracle IR's own release — an error in issue No. 11 propagated from an unverified continuity note; apologies for the miss. Watch: Thursday's Aug. CPI and its FOMC read-through; whether Wednesday's multi-front strikes (Jordan, Saudi Arabia, Black Sea) mark a new escalation baseline or a single spike; Adobe/Oracle earnings after Thursday's close; Delaware's 9/15 primary; Starship Flight 14, 9/15.

Unverified figures are marked in red. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.